The Run Up

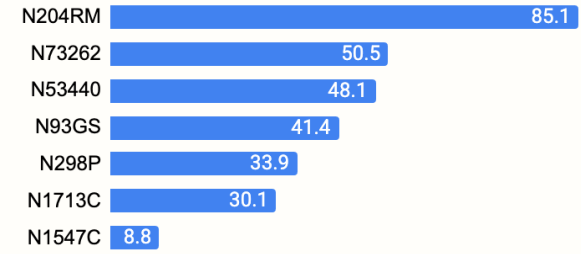
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🍔 QUICK BITES

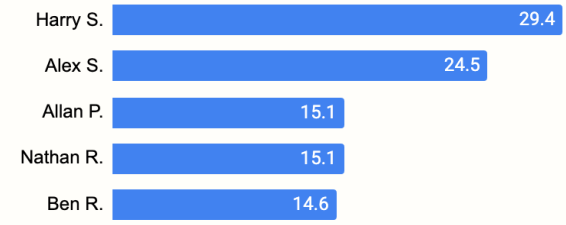
- New Social Co-Chairs **Eve Lopez** and **Elaine Mou** are in-seat. Fly-out to MRY scheduled Sep 12 with additional events to follow rest of year
- **Sam Feldman** is the new Key Captain
- Opportunity to work with students interested in aviation via EAA Compton – reach out to **Kris Maine** for details
- N204RM shared agreement extended for one year – thank you **Harry Sax**!
- Non-Equity Membership tier is live. Dues are $205/month, no buy-in, no waitlist, restricted to 47C (SR-22) and 4RM (SR-20) operations only
- Membership interest continues to grow with 25+ people on the waitlist and 15+ new Non-Equity or Social Members since May 2026
- Flightbase.ai live for Club Service management; need beta testers for migration later this year – reach out to **Nate Siahpush, Ari Levine, Adrian Santos,** or **Rahul Chandra** for more info
- New website launched – SaveSMO.org – with information on how to get involved in the effort
- Q2 2026 data and financials now available in Data Dashboard – see member portal for details
- As of June 30, trailing-twelve-month flying surpassed 1,500 hours, **the highest in five years**
- Membership Profile Pages coming soon – reach out to **Adrian Santos** with questions or ideas
- New toolkit available in the hangar – help yourselves as needed for Part 43 preventative maintenance. Thank you **Matthew Setzer**!
- Hangar restoration and improvement project underway. Send ideas or input to Hangar Captain (**Alex Silver**) or Social Chairs
- SMO administration now mostly remote, underscoring need increased vigilance on field
- Proposal submitted from SMAA to City requesting Iron Tire Dolly for transporting disabled aircraft off runways and taxiways

✈️ LEADERBOARD

Billed Hours by Aircraft (July 1 – August 31)



Active Pilots (July 1 – August 31)



Includes Harry's 4RM OSH trip of 29.4 hours. Runner-up active pilot Elaine M.

⚒️ FLEET AND MAINTENANCE HIGHLIGHTS

- 262: Lingering PTT and JPI k-factor issues
- 440: GI-275 EIS installation complete
- 98P: 530W maintenance underway; engine monitor TBD ahead of overhaul
- 13C: New ignition harness following mag issues
- 3GS: Continued "non-overspeed" issue
- 4RM: Flying great, members thankful for AC
- 47C: Ongoing engine instrument sensor issues

📅 UPCOMING MEETINGS AND EVENTS

MRY Fly-Out and Lunch | SMO → MRY	Sat Sep 12
Member Meeting | The Six Chow House	Wed Sep 16
Member Meeting | The Six Chow House	Wed Oct 14
WINGS Talk | TBD	Thu Oct 22

Note: All meeting minutes available on member website

The Run Up

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SUMMER RECAP: AIR SHOWS, FLYOUTS, RACES

Airspacers Board

It was a busy summer filled with fly-outs, meet-ups at airshows, participation in air races, and other events with old and new members. Here are a few highlights:

EAA AirVenture / Oshkosh

Oshkosh 2026 was an epic celebration of aviation and America's 250th birthday. Several members were in attendance, including **Matthew Setzer, Ryan Haid, Ian Dutton, Alex Silver,** and **Harry Sax**. Harry made the ~30-hour round-trip flight from SMO in 4RM. The firework, drone, air, and pyrotechnics show on Wednesday night was one for the books.



*Members **Ryan Haid, Matthew Setzer,** and **Ian Dutton** in front of the Douglas DC-3 at Oshkosh*

COPA / CPPP Sacramento

A number of our Cirrus pilots attended the Cirrus Owners & Pilots Association in Sacramento, including **Kris Maine, Aaron Weisblatt, Andrew Jackson, Alex Silver,** and **Oliver Graff**. Part of our Cirrus fleet — 3GS and 47C — were in attendance as well.



*Members **Alex Silver, Oliver Graff, Kris Maine, Andrew Jackson, and Aaron Weisblatt** at COPA*

Palm to Pines Air Race

The Palms to Pines Air Race is a 750-mile air race from Santa Monica to Central Oregon for female pilots, sponsored by the LA 99s. Members cheered on our very own **Eve Lopez**, who averaged over 200 knots GS, beating her handicap by 18 knots, and took home first place out of ~30 pilots. Congratulations Eve! 🥇



The starting line at SMO

(Continued on next page)

Ad Hoc Flyouts and Meetups

One of the best parts about Airspacers is unplanned, spontaneous fly-outs with fellow members. This summer, members flew everywhere from the Bay (SQL, PAO, MRY) to San Diego (CRQ, MYR) to Catalina (AVX) to mid-state (SBA, PRB, SBP) to Arizona (Sedona).



*Members **David Blumstein** and **Jake Sager** on a lunch mission to SBP*



*Members **Ian Dutton, David Slone, Alex Mandelberg**, and **Z Holly** on a drinks mission at The Whaler in Venice*



4RM en route to Sedona



*Members **Nick Katsinas, Nathan Richards, Adam Handwerker, Ryan Haid,** and **Ishan Shah** on a lunch mission to SBA*

🗞️ WELCOME NEW MEMBERS!

- **Mike Hendricks** (Non-Equity)
- **Adam Handwerker** (Social)

Interested in membership? Check out our website.

✅ RATINGS CORNER

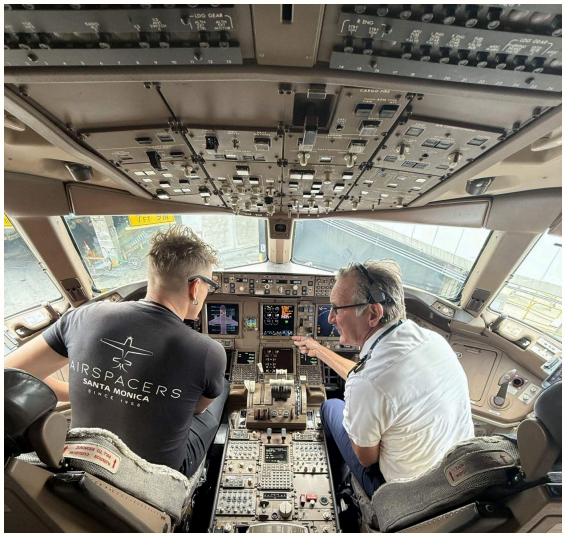
- **Aaron Weisblatt:** Ground Instructor

Congratulations Aaron!

📷 VIEWS FROM THE COCKPIT



*Member **Neil Spears** takes 98P on a tour of Big Sur*



*Member **Matthew Setzer** preflights a 777 at ORD en route to Oshkosh*

ℹ️ ABOUT AIRSPACERS

Founded in 1958, Airspacers Flying Club is the oldest and most established flying club at Santa Monica Airport (KSMO), and one of the longest-running flying clubs in the greater LA area. Our mission has remained the same for over six decades: make the joy of aviation accessible, affordable, and community-driven.

We are a cooperative of 75 equity members, each an equal shareholder of Air-Spacers, Inc., the non-profit entity that owns and operates our aircraft, and an additional 30+ members across our Non-Equity, Social, and Leaseback membership tiers. Our fleet includes seven diverse airplanes, each suited for different styles and missions – available to any qualified member. To learn more, check out our website.

Have an idea for an article? Contact us. We're interested in covering news within the Airspacers and broader Santa Monica aviation communities.